

Hostname Setup — Exam Workstations

Purpose: allow candidates to type `coez.cbt.com:3000` instead of `192.168.0.4:3000` **Applies to:** every exam workstation **Time required:** about 1 minute per machine **Prerequisite:** the app must already load at `http://192.168.0.4:3000`. If it doesn't, stop — fix that first. This procedure only changes the name, not the connection.

1. What this does

The hosts file is a plain text file on every Windows machine that maps names to IP addresses. It is checked *before* any DNS server, so it works even with no DNS on the network and no internet connection.

Adding one line tells the workstation that `coez.cbt.com` means `192.168.0.4`. Nothing is installed and nothing runs in the background.

Why this method for exams: each workstation holds the mapping itself. If the server reboots or the router restarts, name resolution is unaffected — there is no central service to fail.

2. Do this on each workstation

Open PowerShell **as Administrator**: press Start, type `powershell`, right-click **Windows PowerShell**, choose **Run as administrator**. Accept the UAC prompt.

Paste both lines and press Enter:

```
Add-Content -Path "$env:SystemRoot\System32\drivers\etc\hosts" -Value "`n192.168.0.4`tcoez.cbt.com"
ipconfig /flushdns
```

That's the whole procedure. There is no restart and no visible confirmation beyond the flushdns message.

The two backtick characters are required. In the command above, ``n` means new line and ``t` means tab. The backtick key sits above Tab, to the left of the 1 key — it is **not** an apostrophe. If the command errors, this is almost always why. Retype those characters by hand rather than pasting.

3. Verify before moving to the next machine

```
Resolve-DnsName coez.cbt.com
```

The answer should show `192.168.0.4`. Then open a browser and confirm both addresses load:

Address	Should show
<code>http://coez.cbt.com:3000</code>	Candidate login page
<code>http://coez.cbt.com:7000</code>	Admin dashboard

If both load, the machine is done. Set `http://coez.cbt.com:3000` as the browser homepage.

4. Manual method, if PowerShell is blocked

Some locked-down machines restrict PowerShell. The same edit can be made by hand.

1. Press Start, type `notepad`, right-click **Notepad**, choose **Run as administrator**
2. **File → Open**
3. Paste this into the filename box and press Enter: `C:\Windows\System32\drivers\etc\hosts`
4. If the file list appears empty, change the file-type dropdown from *Text Documents* to **All Files**
5. Scroll to the very bottom and add a new line: `192.168.0.4 coez.cbt.com`
6. **File → Save**, then close Notepad
7. Open Command Prompt and run `ipconfig /flushdns`

Use a **Tab or spaces** between the address and the name — not a comma. Lines beginning with `#` are comments and can be ignored.

5. Script for doing many machines quickly

Save this as `set-hostname.ps1` on a USB stick. On each workstation, right-click the file and choose **Run with PowerShell** (as administrator).

```
$hostsFile = "$env:SystemRoot\System32\drivers\etc\hosts"
$ip         = "192.168.0.4"
$name       = "coez.cbt.com"

if (Select-String -Path $hostsFile -Pattern $name -Quiet) {
    Write-Host "Already configured on this machine." -ForegroundColor Yellow
} else {
    Add-Content -Path $hostsFile -Value "`n$ip`t$name"
    Write-Host "Entry added." -ForegroundColor Green
}

ipconfig /flushdns | Out-Null

try {
    $result = Resolve-DnsName $name -ErrorAction Stop
    Write-Host "$name resolves to $($result.IPAddress)" -ForegroundColor Green
} catch {
    Write-Host "FAILED - name did not resolve. Check the entry manually." -ForegroundColor Red
}

Read-Host "Press Enter to close"
```

The check at the top makes this safe to run twice on the same machine — it will not create duplicate entries.

6. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Cause	Fix
Access to the path is denied	PowerShell not running as Administrator	Close it and re-open with Run as administrator
Command runs but name still fails	DNS cache not cleared	Run <code>ipconfig /flushdns</code>
Name resolves to a public address	Entry not saved, or hostname misspelled	Open the hosts file in Notepad and check the last line
Name resolves but page will not load	Not a naming problem	Test <code>http://192.168.0.4:3000</code> directly. If that also fails, the fault is on the network or the server
Backtick characters cause an error	Apostrophe typed instead of backtick	Use the key above Tab, or use the manual method in section 4

To undo the change, open the hosts file in Notepad as Administrator, delete the `coez.cbt.com` line, save, and run `ipconfig /flushdns`.

7. Note for the project lead

`cbt.com` is a domain registered to someone else. It resolves correctly on these workstations because the hosts file takes priority locally, but if a machine is ever moved to a network with internet access and the entry is removed, the name will reach an unrelated public server.

`coez.cbt.internal` or `coez.cbt.lan` are reserved for private networks and carry no such risk. If the name has not yet been printed on candidate instructions, changing it now costs nothing.

Quick reference

Item	Value
Server address	192.168.0.4
Hostname	coez.cbt.com
Candidate URL	http://coez.cbt.com:3000
Admin URL	http://coez.cbt.com:7000
Hosts file location	C:\Windows\System32\drivers\etc\hosts
Verify command	Resolve-DnsName coez.cbt.com
Clear cache	ipconfig /flushdns

Workstations completed: _ of _ Engineer: __ Date: _____